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Great Southern Herald

PUBLISHED WEDNESDAY AND SATURDAY

CIRCULATING THROUGHOUT THE GREAT SOUTHERN DISTRICTS.

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KATANNING, WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 1914.

PRICE: ONE PENNY

News in Brief.

Weather just right for harvesting and shearing.

Reports show the wool-clip well grown.

Hay yields will generally be light, but prices are right.

Katanning Road Board meets Saturday afternoon.

No nominations were received for the vacant seat in the East Ward, which were due on Saturday last.

It doesn't take an experienced eye to note that these boots represent fine value for the money in Sagers Boot Window.—Adv.

Tambellup correspondent reports Mr. F. Murray's sale of "Comeback" chaff at £7 16s 0d at Tingarup siding.

Needless to say there is fair demand for skilled harvesting hands.

As for the cutting and binding machinery, all that is not actually in use, is being refurbished.

Some growers who can afford, are turning down offers of £7 10s-0d, and a little over.

To sell, or not to sell, is too complex a question for light advice.

The seller at present prices does well. The holder may do better—or worse.

Dalgaty and Co., announce in another column an auction sale of 3,500 sheep at Katanning yards on Thursday 19th.

Katanning's water supply is nearing settlement—one way or the other.

The departmental officers have done everything that can reasonably be asked of them.

The scheme has been matured, and all necessary information has been lucidly placed before the ratepayers.

The concrete case quoted by the chairman may help ratepayers to a favorable vote.

Occupier of cottage of £30 rental, will pay £3 per year for 12,000 gallons, with any extra water he may want at 2s 6d per 1,000 gallons.

It now rests with the ratepayers to authorise the necessary expenditure, or to throw the scheme out.

If anyone wanted further information, or had an objection to raise, Monday night's meeting was his opportunity.

The time has now come for prompt action, and it is hoped the Road Board will at once take the referendum required by statute.

All ratepayers within the proposed reticulation area will have the responsibility of saying "Yes" or "No."

The health and comfort of the townspeople are largely at stake, and the ratepayers may be relied upon to decide wisely.

The Nor-West elections left honors even. Liberals won Gascoyne by 141 votes, whilst Labor held Pilbara with 38 to spare.

Katanning people generally would have rejoiced in a win for Michael Corbett, and wish him better luck next time.

Labor is expected to hold Roebourne next Wednesday, thus securing a majority of 2.

Enough to exist upon, but a sad fall from the 18 of last Parliament.

No more bluster about "mandates," but every Minister singing small.

Mr. B. G. Green's well-known hunter and hack, Chester, ridden by C. Barber, scored six wins out of six starts, at Tambellup and Gnowangerup shows.

Mr. J. Fairclough reports the crops at his farm as looking very well since the rain, although just before it came he was going to turn the sheep on it. What he is cutting for hay he expects to go a ton to the acre, and his manager, Mr. Philp, is still more sanguine.

Special display of Gents' Boots in Sagers Boot window.—Adv.

The war grows more terrible day by day, as Germany fall back towards the wall.

The latest equipment of the Kaiser's officer is a revolver in one hand and a "dog whip" in the other!

Raw recruits are driven like sheep to the shambles—for of what account to the Kaiser are "common soldiers."

The Allies' tally of victims last week rose to 50,000 men, whilst Russia accounted for 300,000 in prisoners, killed, and wounded!

R. TREE,

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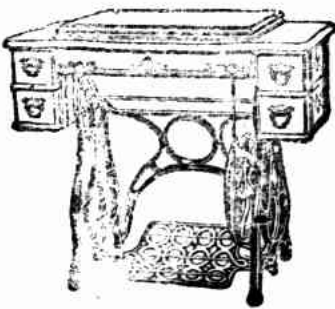
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SHORT STORY.

A BRASS MISUNDERSTANDING.

By N. Kins.

Two people were walking on the set front at Woodleigh, conversing earnestly as they paced slowly along. The girl was young and very pretty, with an air of determination about her firm little chin and piquant nose. The man was her senior by a few years, and had a clever face and a tall, well-built figure. They were both too engrossed with their subject to notice their surroundings at all.

"I say again," said the girl, "that it is quite too ridiculous. You cannot love me when you have known me only a week. Love—oh, love should come because you have learned to admire my character, because you find in me qualities you respect—because I am—"

"Bosh!" interrupted the man impatiently and somewhat rudely. "You are only proving that you are ignorant of the very alphabet of love. Why, I loved you just as soon as I saw you." A smile broke over his face as he went on: "You are my kindred spirit, and I felt it when you looked at me that night by the church door."

But Miss Waring was not to be persuaded. She held theories of her own regarding love, and this man was opposing them in his every word. True she liked him, and found herself wonderfully in sympathy with him, but it was absurd to talk of love. Then how clumsy of him to propose to her as he had done instead of waiting until his devotion had taught her the sweetest lesson on earth! She felt quite angry with him, and snubbed him accordingly.

They stopped at length to watch the sun dip into the sea with its usual ceremonial of crimson sky and golden water. The girl glanced at her companion furtively as he stood looking straight in front of him, with his lips sternly compressed, and a frown upon his forehead.

"He really seems to be miserable," she thought, "but, of course, he must be taught to look at things properly. Besides he will forget me as quickly as he loved me—in a week, at the very least."

His eyes met hers at that moment, and she had the grace to flush suddenly as she saw the sadness in them. His tone was very hopeless as he said:

"Forgive me, Miss Waring, for upsetting your previous conception of love—love made to order. I will not offend again. And now shall we return?"

"How serious he is!" she thought, beginning to wish she had not taken such a high and mighty tone. But somehow she could not tell him this. His manner was cold and formal, and a barrier seemed to have been raised between them.

When they reached their hotel he stooped and held out his hand.

"Good-bye," he said.

"Good-bye," she repeated, wonderingly, letting him retain her fingers; "why good-bye? Surely you are not leaving her because of this?"

She looked straight in his eyes, as was her wont.

He smiled somewhat bitterly. Her tone of speaking of this betrayal too accurately how small a matter it was to her.

"Oh, no," he replied. "My orders came this morning. My paper is sending me with the expedition to Corea as their special representative. That is why I spoke to-day and lost my chance of winning you."

What a strange chill fell over her heart! She shivered slightly. Then the blood mounted to her face as she said, "How long will you be away?"

"About a year," he answered shortly.

"Then if you still care—when you come back—my address is 52, Grosvenor Road."

A rapid change passed over his face. The light came back to his eyes, and with an impulsive movement he took possession of both her hands. "Christine," he breathed, "Does that mean that you bid me hope?"

"A little," she smiled bewilderingly at him. She could not understand herself at all. Some power outside herself seemed to force her actions, for she was acting in defiance of all her accepted traditions.

"May I write?" he pleaded, and she had almost given him permission when it struck her that the test would be surer if they did not communicate at all.

"Much will have more," she said, smiling archly. "No, I must refuse that request, but you may come to me a year from to-day, if you have not utterly forgotten me."

"Forgotten you?" he said, and then, without asking her permission, he drew her to his breast and kissed her once, long and tenderly on her lips.

She wanted to reproach him, but could not, for her heart was fluttering strangely, and she was not sure she could command her voice. Besides, he was speaking with a world of love in his tone.

"That was to help you not to forget me," he said, and the next moment she saw his tall form descend the hotel steps and speed away in the rapidly increasing dusk.

A year had gone by, and it was September again. Christine Waring's heart had grown very much in love with the image of a certain Bertrand During, and her thoughts were with

him more often than not. She scanned the papers eagerly for notices of the Corea Expedition, and began reading up every detail relating to it. Now, as she tried to make her way through the more than usually congested traffic near the Mansion House there was a tender little smile on her lips, and a happy light in her eyes.

"He will come to-day," she was thinking; and at that the smile broke out again, and a pale pink flush spread over her face as she thought of the meeting.

She had come to a crossing, and, looking about for a hansom, she noticed a purse almost at her feet. She picked it up, and, barely looking at it, hailed a passing cab and was soon at home.

Once there, she opened the purse, which contained some gold and several bank notes. There was also a card, which she drew from its place with a sigh of relief. It bore the name of Mrs. Bertrand During, and in the corner an address at Kensington.

She stood for a moment with it in her hands, her heart feeling woefully heavy. Then she sat down and tried to think what it meant. Her prophecy had proved true after all. He had forgotten her. Then her pride rose in arms as she remembered with a pang that she had grown to love him—and he was married. Still it might be a mistake. It might be another Mrs. Bertrand During, though it was hardly likely. Could she find out? She must find out.

So thinking, she rang the bell and despatched her maid with a telegram informing Mrs. Bertrand During that she had found her purse, and asking her to call for it at three o'clock that day.

This done, she settled down to a state of miserable uncertainty. Her common sense told her that after all it was just what she had expected, and yet some intuition bade her disbelieve until she had absolute proof. She counted the minutes by the feverish beatings of her heart, and wondered what Bertrand's wife would be like—pretty, no doubt, and assuredly clever. She felt she almost hated her, whoever she was.

At three o'clock precisely she heard a ring and braced herself for the coming ordeal. A minute later the door opened, and the maid announced Mr. Bertrand During. Christine's heart stopped beating for a second, and her face paled. Till then she did not know how much she had hoped. Now, indeed, she was satisfied. He had come instead of his wife, and she would have need of all her strength to enable her to guard her secret. He was smiling down on her, not seeming in the least surprised, she noticed, though she had only signed her surname to the telegram. He called her by her Christian name, too, and held her hand for quite a long time.

At last she managed to regain her faltering breath and listen to what he was saying. She could tell he was talking in an aimless sort of way, and wondering at her want of composure. She hated herself for her lack of self-control.

Presently he bent forward and said: "Christine, I cannot wait any longer. Will you give me what I came for?"

"Oh, yes," she answered, mechanically, moving to the table whereon the purse was laid.

He rose too, and was coming towards her when he gave a startled exclamation. She followed his glance, and saw a lady coming across the lawn.

"Oh, I cannot stand her," she heard him mutter under his breath. Then he divined behind a screen, saying, "Get rid of her soon, Christine, for the love of heaven."

Utterly bewildered, she turned round as the door opened, and a lady announced as Mrs. Bertrand During entered.

Christine bowed stiffly as her eyes took in the personality of the new arrival. She was dressed youthfully, in the extreme fashion, but under her make-up the signs of age were very apparent. She was fifty years old at least. A horrible feeling of repulsion swept over Christine's mind, and she hated the vulgar woman, and she hated the man who could marry her and yet evidently loathe her.

She was perfectly composed now, and idly indifferent to them both.

"This is your purse, Mrs. During," she said, briefly. "I picked it up outside Mappin and Webb's this morning."

"Ah, thanks," answered that lady, fanning herself with a paper she picked up from the table. "It's very hot, isn't it? My husband was coming, but he backed out at the last moment, so I had to dress in a hurry and come off."

Christine preserved a stolid silence, while her visitor rattled from one topic to another. At length, somewhat cooler than she was at her entrance, she took her leave, giving Christine a cordial invitation to her mansion at Kensington.

When the door closed upon her Miss Waring turned in a white heat of indignation to Bertrand, who came from behind the screen and dropped into a chair, with a complacent smile and a twinkle of amusement in his eyes.

"What an eternity she stayed!" he remarked. "And fancy you finding her purse! You should have seen her face when she discovered her loss this morning."

Christine looked at him scornfully. "You appear surprised," she said. "Do you forget you came for her purse by appointment at three o'clock to-day?"

He started to his feet in sudden anger.

"By heaven, I did not," he answered emphatically. "My appointment was made a whole year ago; do you not remember, Christine?"

His face fell as a thought suddenly struck him.

"And that was what you meant when I asked you to give me what I came for. You thought—you actually thought—I meant that wretched purse."

"Yes," she replied, then asked tremulously, "who is she?"

"She is the newly-wedded wife of my uncle Bertrand, at whose house I am staying."

There was a long silence. Miss Waring could not lift her eyes; she felt he was watching her attentively.

"Then he said softly, coming nearer, 'Chris, little Chris, when I came in I felt so sure of your love. I saw it in your eyes. I read it as you hand touched mine. Tell me, dearest, that my year of weary loneliness is over, and that my little love will reward me at last.'"

"Oh, Bertrand," she sobbed, "I thought that dreadful woman was your wife, and my heart felt broken, for I love you."

But Christine always calls herself Mrs. Berne During to distinguish herself from her aunt-in-law.

BUSINESS AND MARRIAGE.

This is a question that is very often asked, and therefore it is probably of general interest to our readers. There is nothing very original in the question, but for all that it is worth considering, for even the newest of New Women generally look forward to love and marriage as keenly as did their ancestors in the Dark Ages, when women's rights were unknown, and bloomers and bicycles were undreamt of.

Women are by no means to be despised for looking forward to love and marriage, for it is a right and natural instinct. According to the poet,

Man's love is of man's life a thing apart;

And I believe that up till now in ninety-nine cases out of a hundred his statement about women was correct enough. At the present time, however, a change has come over a great number of our sex; they are forced into the outside world to win their bread, and for them, as for men love must be a thing apart—a pleasant sort of possibility which may be in store for them, but which they must waste no time in dreaming about, so busy are they in the battle of life and the struggle for an honorable independence.

Business and professional women and girls, however, have rarely any real enthusiasm for work for work's sake, and nearly all of them look forward to retiring from it to a home life presently. In the time which they hope is coming, a husband naturally figures, for though "digging" may be dignified by the name of home, everyone knows it is a mere make-believe, and that a real home is a place where husband and wife live together in unity.

Woman's temperament does not fit her for business life. She is too sensitive and highly strung to feel happy and at home in the bustle and rush of commercial life, and though her position may appear enviable to others she will often ask herself whether her success has not been too dearly bought. She tries, perhaps, to cheat herself into the belief that she rejoices in her independence, but in ninety-nine cases out of a hundred, she feels a longing envy of those of her friends whose duties are of the home, and whose chief interest is in the happiness of husband and children.

If she be a thoughtful woman, she will see that though necessity compels her, and an ever increasing number of her sex, to compete with men in the labour market, the entrance of women into trades and professions hitherto closed to them is by no means all gain, even to themselves. It might be if they received payment according to the value of their work; but though a woman may do exactly the same work as a man, and perhaps do it better, she extremely rarely has the same wage. She knows perfectly well that if she does not accept whatever an employer offers there are scores of women who would gladly do so. Employers know it, too, and profit by it, and the result is that already men are being forced out of their employment by women, and those who have homes find it impossible to maintain them, and the rest are doomed to celibacy.

Thus does business life interfere with the matrimonial prospects of women, and those prospects will become worse and worse until wages are paid according to the value of the work and regardless of the sex of the worker.

If a woman compete in the labour market with men from necessity and with the laudable desire not to be burdensome to her relatives, she will have the respect of men; but they have little liking for the woman who enters the lists with them simply because she cannot find sufficient scope for her talents in the ordinary interests and employments of her sex. They may admire her cleverness and her ability to support herself, but when looking out for a wife they will choose someone who is less self-reliant, and who will depend a little more on the man to whom she gives her hand and heart.

Far and Near.

DEVoured BY WOLVES.

HERE have been very heavy snowfalls in Russia, and in the neighbourhood of Odessa trains have been snowed up with terrible consequences. By Monday the snowdrifts were successfully cleared, and the last of the snowed-up trains arrived at Odessa safely with passengers and 2,500 bags of mail. Scores of trucks containing carcasses of cattle frozen to death on sidings were cut out. The snowdrift for miles hardened to the consistency of ice. In one spot a temporary tunnel had to be cut through an ice-drift 400 yards long by 35 ft. deep. On Monday 700 passengers quitted the snowed-up trains near Hazzelnaia, mostly in peasant sleighs, arriving at a point north of Odessa more dead than alive. Poorer passengers struck out on foot. Many lay down by the roadside exhausted and suffering from hunger and cold, and were found later by sleigh parties frozen to death. Feeling has run high against the South-Western railroad authorities, whose rigid policy in refusing to accede to the demands of the snowdigging gangs for 3s per day of 12 hours is said to be mainly responsible for the awful suffering and mortality.

There was a carnival on the ice at Monnikendam on Sunday. Roundabouts and booths were erected, and people paraded in old Dutch costumes. Thousands of skaters were present, and the Transvaal and Orange Free State flags were in evidence.

While two young artists and a lady friend were skating on Sunday, in the neighbourhood of Potsdam, they fell through the ice at a spot where, owing to the current, it was not very thick. The lady was saved at both the artists were drowned.

Since the year began snowdrifts have completely disorganised railway traffic in Roumania. One train on the night of the 2nd inst. ran into a snowdrift, which put out the fires, and the sufferings experienced by the travellers were frightful, some of them falling into a state of coma. Happily another train came to the rescue. Several villagers were completely buried, and deaths from cold are reported among the peasantry. From all parts come accounts of the depredations caused by the packs of starving wolves. At Machin, a village near the town of Braila, two Turkish workmen were attacked and devoured, and from Moldavia news comes of three different cases where persons were attacked and eaten.

The correspondent of the "Morning Leader" at Buda-Pesth tells a tragic story of two brothers, Franz and Anton Falcsy, who married two sisters named Anna and Marie Jozsffy in the Marmaros comitato. After the couples had been united in wedlock at church they started in a sleigh on a visiting trip to old and feeble relations living in the neighbouring villages before again joining their guests at the wedding breakfast. This is the custom, and the happy couples wished to make no exception. On approaching the forest of Borgo-twei, the sleigh was attacked by two wolves. The driver, relying on the speed of his horses, wanted to get away, but one of the bridegrooms drew his revolver and shot one of the brutes. Instantly a herd of wolves which, exasperated by the cold weather, had advanced to the border of the forest, attacked the party. The driver escaped to the top of a tree, but the two couples became the prey of the infuriated beasts. A search party of the wedding guests, who had tired of waiting, found the driver almost frozen to death on the tree, and discovered part of the remains of the four victims.

According to a telegram from Buda-Pesth many people have been attacked by wolves on the frontier of Galicia. The driver of a mail cart was attacked and devoured.

THE ISLAND OF MYSTERY.

The deserted Channel Islands of the Pacific have at last undergone a thorough exploration by Professor Charles Frederick Holden, with the result that much of absorbing interest regarding the extinct inhabitants of these lovely isles has been discovered. He visited San Nicolas, Santa Catalina, and San Clemente, and made many excavations and many rich finds. Giants once lived on the exquisitely lovely Channel Islands, for many skeletons have been found there more than seven feet high. Tradition has it that the warlike tribes of the Aleutian Islands came down in boats more than a century ago and practically exterminated the Channel Islanders. Certain it is that most of the unhappy wretches met death by violence, for nearly all the skulls discovered are crushed by blows from blunt instruments. The club is the weapon of the Aleutian savage, and this seems to fit the tradition. A few escaped, and up to about sixty years ago the remnants of the tribe were still living on San Nicolas. In 1835 the Franciscans of the Santa Barbara mission, learning that there were but a few of the strange Indian race then living, determined to rescue them. They went over in a sloop and succeeded in getting all on board. At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child, and one of the frequent storms of the Channel Islands springing up, the sloop was driven away. It went on the rocks near Point Conception, and all on board were lost. So only this woman was

left, and she was soon forgotten. In 1851, however, Captain George Nidever visited the island to hunt sea otter, and was amazed to find human footprints in the sand. Two years later he returned to investigate the matter, and succeeded in capturing the remaining Indian, now an old woman. She was dressed in birdskins, and was engaged in scraping blubber from a seal. They took her to Santa Barbara, where she lived for several years, and was known far and wide as "the lone woman of San Nicolas." But she never learned enough English to be able to tell anything of the life and tradition of her strange race. Professor Holden, in his exploration just concluded, found many large mounds in San Nicolas, one 300 feet long by 50 wide, composed of abalone shells, which were brought from the sea two miles distant, thus showing evidence of a large population. He found objects of stone, bone, and shell piled in heaps. There were pendants, rings, beads, and curious objects in pearl among them, proving that the extinct people loved ornamentation. That they played games was shown by the finding of perforated and oval stones, and many small and peculiarly shaped instruments. Some of the mortars picked up were very high and narrow, others so heavy there was great difficulty in rolling them down to the ship. One showed evidence of ornamentation with abalone. Sculptured forms of miniature sea lions and whales carved from serpentine prove a love of art in the aborigines. According to Professor Holden the islanders depended for food on abalone, fish, and possibly roots. Consequently they belonged to an advanced period of the stone age. San Clemente, 2 1/2 miles long by three wide, Professor Holden found contained much evidence of ancient habitation. Possibly 300 years ago it had a large population. One square mile of its area was covered with skeletons, shells, and ancient implements and mortars, some ones weighing one hundred pounds. Santa Catalina is a high mountain ridge, the only landing places being the mouths of canyons. Professor Holden declares that the islands were inhabited for many centuries, for he found heaps of abalone shells on the seashore, covered with 20 feet of a deposit, which he calculates required centuries for its formation. The islands have been a mine of archaeological treasure ever since 1872, when the first systematic exploration was made by Mr. W. G. W. Harford. From the graveyards were unearthed a large number of skeletons each surrounded by marvellous examples of the products and handicraft of the long past dead. The graves, as described by those investigators and others, make an interesting story of themselves. The skeletons lay crowded together in every conceivable position, sometimes superimposed three or four deep, those below, forgotten and unmarked, ruthlessly disturbed to make room for the last interment. Some of the graves had rude boxes constructed of the huge fat bones of whales, in which the dead were deposited. The early sea captains related gruesome tales of the islands, where, within yawning skeletons of whales, lay the grinning and bleached bones of men, exposed to view by the careless shifting of the sands. One type of the remarkable finds made in the graves is the gigantic soapstone, or steatite, pot, which stand absolutely alone as monuments to the cleverness of the early inhabitants of these islands. Some of them are fully two and a half feet in diameter, almost globular in form, with very thin walls, and carefully polished over their entire inner and outer surface. It is astounding how these ancient peoples carved and modelled such symmetrical and fragile vessels from this material, but nevertheless fully three-fourths of the vessels used for cooking and ceremonial purposes were adroitly fashioned from it. For most of the pipes, gorgets, mortars, animal figures, pendants, net sinkers and the like the same stone was utilised.

Descriptive.

ROMANCE OF FIRING LINE.

REGARDING the composition of our army at the front in South Africa, one narrator says: "We found men out there who had been wild, and whose parents were glad to see them enter the army; we found men who had been crossed in love; we found men who had been a failure in life, even if they were mere youths; we found many dare-devils, and, curiously enough, most of them were cautious on the firing line. But of all the curious characters I came across the strangest was of a man named Bond. Bond gradually became reckless on the firing line. Any one could see it was not assumed, but was genuine, and his conduct deepened the mystery as to his past, and made Peter the more zealous to find out all about him."

One day Bond fell with a wound. Peters carried him to the rear, cared for him, stayed by him as long as he could, did everything that could be done under the circumstances, like offering to write home, and all that sort of thing. Bond spent half an hour in deep thought. He was apparently sizing up his chances of living. He was also thinking whether it was worth while to forgive Peters for the past or to give

him a thrust he would never forget. It was about midnight that Peters returned to his place with us, and the next morning he had a story to tell to three of us in whom he confided.

Maxwell paused, and just as his hearers were becoming uneasy he said this was the story Peters had related—

"Boys, we've got a murderer amongst us. It's a mighty sad story."

Bond told me that his father was a bank president and was found murdered in the bank two years ago. Robbers had killed him and had made their escape. He had evidently surprised them. Young Bond was the real murderer. He was just under 21. He had been stealing from his father's private business for more than a year so as to keep on gambling with a set of fast young fellows whom a sharper got together regularly and was plundering right along. In Bond's twenty-first birthday there had to be a settlement of the books, for his father intended to take him into business partnership. Bond had to get not less than £1000 to make good his stealing. There was no other way left to him than to steal it. He knew all about the bank, the combinations to the locks, the ways of the watchman, and all that. He left liquor that had been doctored with drugs for the watchman to drink, knowing the man's weakness, and the rest was easy. He entered the bank from the rear stealthily, having made sure the watchman was unconscious, had just got into the inner vault, when he heard a noise and saw a dim light in the outer room. He knew it could not be the watchman, and he at once raised his revolver for action and crouched to one side. Then he heard a voice saying—My God, I must have killed him. I didn't know it was so powerful. Wake up, Mike!"

There was no response, and Bond says he recognised the voice as that of his father just in time, for he intended to shoot and escape in a rush if possible. Then Bond became conscious of his own danger. His father might shoot him. The father soon saw the open doors of the vault. What does this mean? he cried. Mike, you didn't do this; you couldn't! Who is there? Speak, or I'll shoot. Quick! Then it was that Bond saw he had no show and he shouted to his father not to shoot, and revealed his own identity.

Then there followed a strange scene in that bank vault. There were the father, the son, and the unconscious watchman together in the early hours of the morning. What does this mean, son? said the father sternly. Has it come to this—my son a bank robber? Young Bond, said he was game, and he replied—What are you doing here? Are you a bank robber yourself? Who put Mike in this condition? You see he had overheard his father make that exclamation about Mike, and he took chances. Explain your position on the inside of that vault, said the father. Explain what you said about not knowing that something was so powerful when you saw Mike, said the son. And then the father broke down completely and the son went to pieces, and each thinking that Mike was about to be confessed to the other. The father had been speculating in the Eastern markets, had used up a lot of trust funds in his charge, and the only way for him to get out was to rob his own bank. He had also left some drops for the watchman, and it was the combined dose that made father and son think that the man would die. The son owned up to the father, and then followed a discussion as to what was best to be done.

They agreed that the bank must be robbed; that was their only salvation. They agreed also that it would be best for one of them to appear to be defending the bank's treasure. It was finally decided that it would be best for the son to wound his father slightly in the side, take enough money to suit their purpose, and leave his father there to be discovered in the morning. The old man said he was so desperate that he would take chances, and he would tell a story about feeling uneasy in his dreams as to the condition of affairs at the bank, and of getting up in the night and going down there to see if all was right, of encountering a robber, a set of robbers, of having a mighty struggle with them, ending, so far as he could recollect, with a revolver shot which made him unconscious. He had no fear as to Mike. If Mike recovered he would be so ashamed of being drunk that he would invent some story of being gagged, especially as father and son had arranged to bind him with a gag and tie his hands.

Then father and son planned the details of the shooting, disarranged the furniture, bound and gagged the watchman, took the money and broke the locks, and the father lay down after tearing his clothes, and had the son give him what he supposed was only a slight flesh wound in the side. The old man was full of nerve, and after the shooting was over hurried the son away, and told him how to act when the discovery was made in the morning. They had wounded the watchman also. Bond says he went home and to bed, and acted his part thoroughly when they roused him to tell him of the dreadful accident to his father. It turned out really to be a dreadful affair, for both the father and the watchman

were found dead and the bank robbed. Young Bond says he made good his gambling debt, and enlisted in the army so as to get away from the storm that arose when it was found that the father was insolvent. It soon became the general theory in the town that the elder Bond had gone there to rob the bank, and had been killed by a real bank robber, and there were those who thought they could remember the exact looks of certain mysterious strangers that had been seen about town.

The one thing I can't understand, said Peters, in telling the story, is why he wants me to write all this before he dies. He must have a terrible conscience. He said to me, I am wounded exactly in the place in which my father was wounded when I shot him. I know I can't live. Just tell the truth about me, and make sure the boys will not despise me too much. I have done my duty by them and by the flag, says he. I broke down and wept, I'll admit, and I'm prepared to say that there's no living soul but has some good in them. And then there's the duty of deciding what's to be done if Bond recovers. Ought we to give him away? I say no.

According to Maxwell the bugles just then blew for a forward movement, and soon all were lying on the firing line shooting. Maxwell made another awkward pause, and one of his auditors said—Well, I suppose Bond really died, and you fellows die the right thing by him even in death. Die? said Maxwell. Great Scott, no. At least, not then. Less than two hours after Peters had told that story Bond came stealing up to the firing line, and there he lay next to me all day working like a demon. I thought you were dying, I said to him. The devil, no, he replied. It was only a little wound. I told him that you were dying. I thought it about time to call him off and make him a laughing stock. What's that? Am I hurt? Yes, old man, I guess I am. I saw that he had been seriously wounded this time. Maxwell, I guess you had better tell Peters to write that story home after all, just as I told it to him. I thought I was dying, or near to it, last night when I talked to him. I'm going—now. Be—sure—to—tell—him—to—write—Was he really a murderer and bank robber? asked one of Maxwell's listeners. The army records do not show that he was, was the response.

Health Notes.

ONE vital condition for good health is pure air. Now this happens to be a very sore subject with sanitarians, because of the utter neglect with which it is treated by the people. While the people know that food and water are necessary for the continuance of life, they do not seem to regard air as a necessity at all. They are careless whether they get pure or impure air, and the consequence is that they suffer from a whole crop of chest and throat (and other) ailments, due to the weakening of the system through breathing air which has become foul from one cause or another. Let us think of this matter seriously for a moment. We can last a good long time without food or water. On water alone, a man will survive for many days, but we are not always demanding supplies of either food or drink. When it comes to air, however, we at once see that two or three minutes' deprivation of this necessity of life suffices to kill us. Therefore, of the three things demanded for our existence, air is by far the most important. That is a self-evident fact.

Now, consider our relations to water and food, and to air respectively. We have to get food, and to prepare it for our consumption. Similarly, we have to bring water into our houses by works costing in the case of big cities, millions of money. Yet air, which we want every moment of our lives—and pure air it should be—we make no provision for supplying at all. I can easily prove my words to be true. Take an ordinary room; it is simply a box, more or less airtight. There are four sides, a roof, and a floor. We enter the room. Where, may I ask, do we get the air supply, without which we cannot live? I answer by chance, and without an intelligent appreciation of the need for fresh air and the importance of procuring it. Air comes into the room by the crevices of the windows and underneath the door. It may even come in through the walls if they are sufficiently porous, being drawn in from the outside by the heat of the room. This is how we get our air supply. It is all a matter of haphazard chance, and we think nothing whatever about it. As a consequence, we suffer from colds and coughs, from weak lungs, and from a whole variety of other troubles, and all because we will not pay as much attention to the air we breathe as we do to our supply of water or of food.

To put the matter plainly, in air which is of ordinary purity, we find oxygen, nitrogen, carbonic acid gas (four parts in ten thousand of air), with other substances. The chief of the latter is that I have called organic matter. Now this matter has assumed a high importance in late years in the area of sanitation.

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